Requesting software that isn't in the catalog

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Summary

This article guides users and service-desk agents through the process when a requested software title is not present in the Acme Global Company Portal catalog. It explains how to verify availability, submit a formal request, and what steps the Application Support team takes to approve, package, or escalate the installation.

Symptoms

- Software Center or Company Portal does not list the requested application
- Attempt to install fails with error 0x80070005 (Access denied) or a similar permission message
- User sees a notice that the software is not approved or requires administrator rights
- Search returns no results and there is no Install button available

Common causes

- The requested software is not part of the approved application catalog
- Licensing or security review is pending for the title
- The specific version requested has not been packaged for deployment via Intune
- The software requires elevated privileges beyond a standard user scope
- Temporary restriction due to a vulnerability, compliance issue, or expiration of a license

Understanding the Software Catalog

Acme Global maintains a curated catalog of applications that have been vetted for security, licensing, and compatibility. The catalog is exposed through the Company Portal (Intune) and is the only source from which standard users can install software without administrative intervention. Titles outside this catalog either lack approval, have not been packaged, or are subject to additional review.

Self-Help: Check Company Portal and Request Approved Software

Before opening a ticket, users should verify whether the software is already available under a different name or version, and then use the built-in request workflow if it is truly missing.

1. 1. Open the Company Portal app (Windows) or website https://portal.manage.microsoft.com (macOS) and sign in with your Acme credentials.
2. 2. Use the search bar to look for the software title; try common variants (e.g., "Python 3.12", "VS Code", "Adobe Reader DC").
3. 3. If the application appears, select it and click **Install**. Follow any on-screen prompts; the installation will run in the background and notify you when complete.
4. 4. If the search returns no results, click the **Request Software** link (usually found at the bottom of the catalog page).
5. 5. Fill in the request form: provide the exact software name, desired version, business justification, and any required add-ons or licenses.
6. 6. Submit the request. You will receive a confirmation email with a ticket number; the Application Support team will review the request and contact you if additional information is needed.

Service Desk: Processing a Software Installation Request

Agents follow a standardized workflow to evaluate, approve, and deploy software that is not currently in the catalog. This ensures compliance with licensing, security, and packaging standards.

1. 1. Verify the user's request against the ticket details: software name, version, justification, and any attached license documents.
2. 2. Check the existing Application Catalog (via Intune admin center) to confirm the title is truly absent or only available under a different naming convention.

3. 3. Consult the Licensing Management database to determine if Acme owns a valid license for the requested version; if not, flag the request for procurement.
4. 4. Submit the software to the Security Operations team for a vulnerability and compliance review (if the title is not already on the approved list). Attach the Security Review Request form and await their clearance.
5. 5. Once cleared, package the application using the standard Intune Win32 app or macOS pkg workflow, assign it to the appropriate device group, and set the deployment to **Available** (not required).
6. 6. Notify the user via email or Teams that the software is now available in Company Portal and provide installation instructions.
7. 7. Close the ticket after confirming the user has successfully installed the software or after 5 business days of no response.

Verification and Closure

After the software is made available, both the user and the agent should confirm that the installation completed successfully and that the application functions as expected. This step reduces repeat tickets and ensures the catalog remains accurate.

1. 1. Ask the user to launch the newly installed program and verify the version number matches the request.
2. 2. Confirm that the application can perform a basic task (e.g., run a simple script in Python, open a PDF in Adobe Reader, edit a file in VS Code).
3. 3. If the user reports any errors, collect error messages and logs, then re-escalate to the appropriate support group (Desktop Support for runtime issues, Application Support for packaging problems).
4. 4. Document the final outcome in the ticket, including any workaround or additional configuration applied.
5. 5. Mark the ticket as **Resolved** and close it after user confirmation.

Additional Tips and Best Practices

Following these practices helps keep the software catalog up-to-date and reduces unnecessary tickets.

1. - Always search the Company Portal first; many applications are listed under vendor-specific names (e.g., "Microsoft Visual Studio Code" vs. "VS Code").
2. - When requesting software, include the exact version number and a clear business need; this speeds up the Security and Licensing reviews.
3. - Keep a personal record of approved software you frequently use; if you notice a missing title, suggest it via the quarterly Software Catalog Feedback survey.
4. - For developers needing frequent updates to tools like Python packages or Node.js modules, consider using the approved language-specific package managers (pip, npm) that are already allowed within the Intune-managed environment.
5. - If you encounter a recurring need for a particular unapproved tool, discuss with your manager and the Application Support lead to evaluate adding it to the standard catalog.

When to escalate

If the Security Operations team determines that the requested software poses a risk or requires a exception that cannot be granted, the ticket should be escalated to the Application Support Lead (or the IT Security Manager) with the following details: ticket number, software name and version, licensing status, security review findings, and any alternative solutions already considered. The escalation must be made via the IT Help Teams channel, tagging @ApplicationSupport-Lead, and the agent should attach the Security Review Request form and the license inquiry report.

Keywords: software request, application not in catalog, Company Portal install failed, request software, install Python, install VS Code, install Adobe Reader, missing application, software approval, Intune request, licensing review, security review